



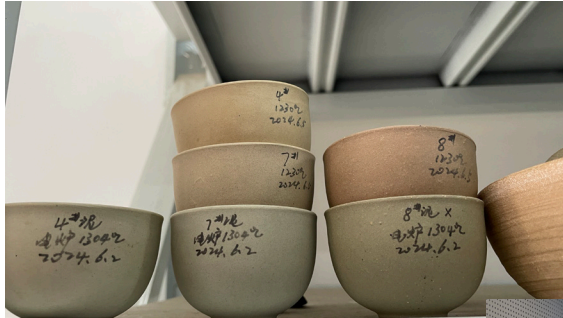
The Balance and the Beauty Beneath the Porcelain

The history of ceramics in Jingdezhen dates back to the Han dynasty, giving the city over 2,000 years of pottery-making heritage. Today, Jingdezhen skillfully combines its natural advantages — including high-quality clay, abundant forest resources, and convenient transportation — with centuries-old craftsmanship, a well-established industrial chain, and

an increasingly open market. As a result, this fourth-tier city has gained growing attention in recent years for its vibrant ceramic culture, thriving cultural and creative industries, and the unique “Jingpiao” phenomenon, where artists and creators from across China and beyond are drawn to settle and work in the city.

Design project by
Xiyue Zhang

Market Observations in Jingdezhen

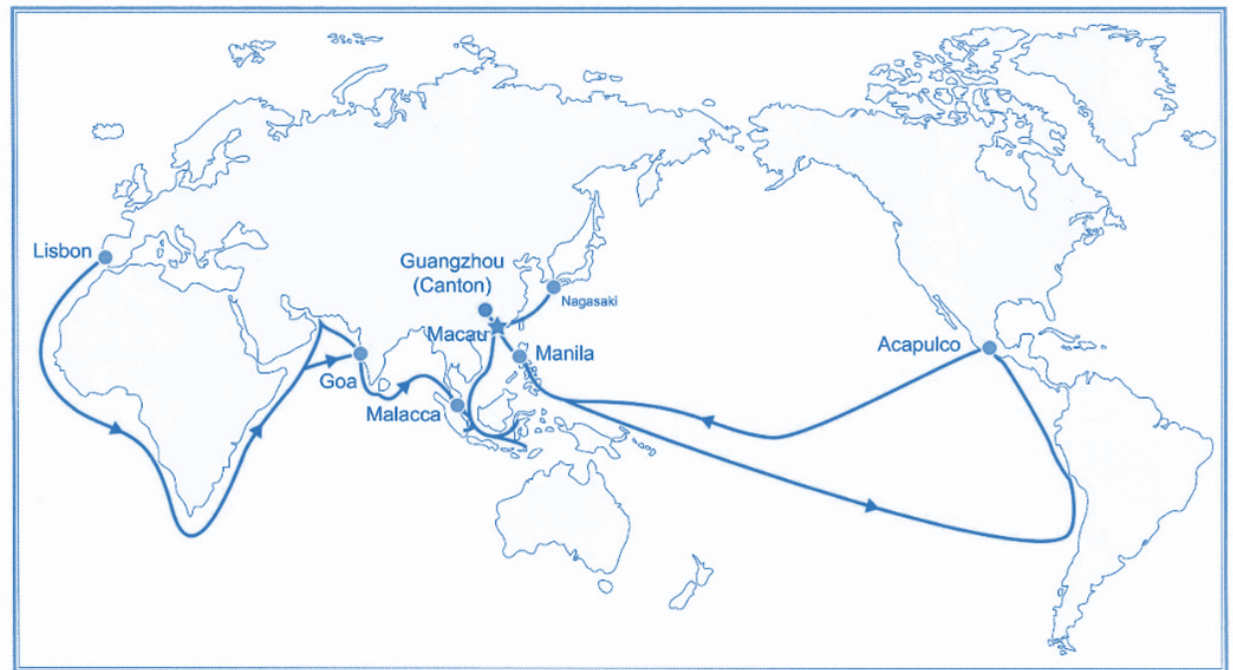


Upon arriving in Jingdezhen, I was immediately struck by the overwhelming presence of ceramics that permeates every corner of the city. From bustling street markets to rows of exhibition booths, ceramic works in countless forms and styles filled the scene. Yet, standing in the heart of this vibrant hub also led me to a pressing question:

In a market so densely packed and fiercely competitive, how does one find a meaningful breakthrough?

As I delved deeper into local research and observation, I began to notice a recurring pattern — despite the abundance of products, many shared similar styles and functions, resulting in a high degree of homogeneity. At the same time, consumers are showing growing interest in ceramic products that align more closely with modern lifestyles and demonstrate true innovation. This shift in demand may well represent a new opportunity — one that calls for creativity, differentiation, and a deeper connection with contemporary living.

Porcelain as a Lens on Historical Globalization



Ancient Export Porcelain

During my visit to the Jingdezhen Export Porcelain Museum, I found a spark of inspiration. Archaeological evidence shows that the export of Chinese ceramics began no later than the Tang dynasty. At the time, porcelain was often traded as a prized specialty along the Silk Road, reaching distant regions such as Japan, Korea, Southeast Asia, South Asia, the Middle East, and even parts of Africa.

How Export Porcelain Adapted to Different Cultural Contexts



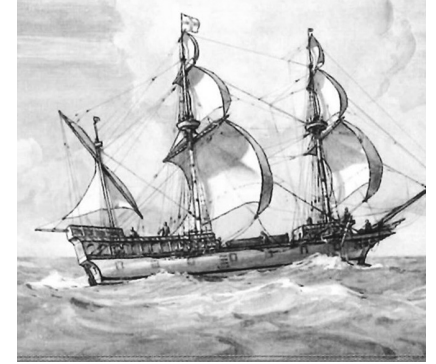
Yuan Dynasty Blue and White Porcelain Dish

The large dish was created for the Islamic market. Its wide, shallow shape was specifically designed to suit the local custom of eating with hands from shared platters, often with rice and meat dishes.



Kraak Porcelain

This ceramic was originally made for Portuguese merchants, decorated with bordered panels and patterns inspired by European prints. When a ship carrying these goods, named the “Kraak,” was captured by the Dutch, the porcelain style came to be known by the ship’s name.



Southeast Asia Tea Set

The small, delicate tea sets were exported to Southeast Asia, especially to places like Fujian and nearby regions with a strong kung fu tea culture.



Porcelain Creamer Made for the British Market

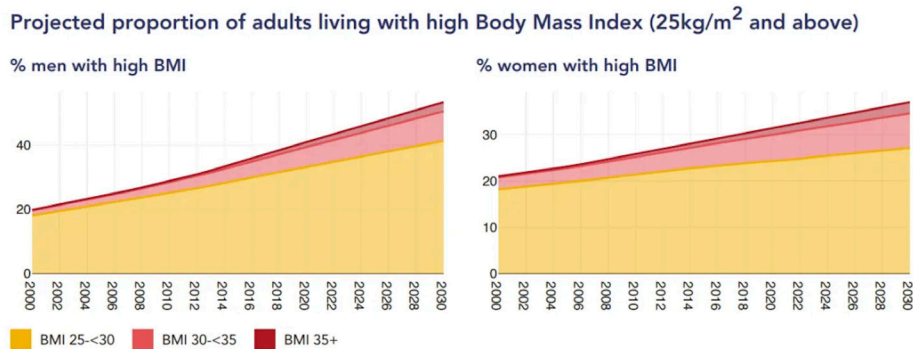
This ornate creamer was crafted specifically for British tastes, featuring colorful hand-painted scenes and a European-style shape suited to serving milk or cream with tea.



The design of export porcelain often closely reflected the lifestyles of different cultural regions, showing a remarkable ability to adapt and integrate across diverse traditions. This thoughtful blending of function and cultural relevance made each piece more than just an object — it became a bridge between worlds. It made me begin to wonder:

In today's world, what should tableware look like if it is to truly reflect our “new lifestyle”?

The Global Obesity Report



The Global Obesity Report

The World Obesity Atlas 2025, released by the World Obesity Federation, highlights that obesity has become a truly global issue. Projections indicate that by 2030, more than 2.9 billion adults worldwide will have a high BMI, with over 1.1 billion classified as obese ($\text{BMI} \geq 30$).

This growing trend is having a profound impact on global health systems.



Speaking from personal experience, I was once a figure skater. However, after a serious injury forced me to stop training and academic pressures began to pile up, I gained nearly 20 kilograms over the course of four years. This year, I made the decision to commit to healthy weight loss. With guidance from a nutritionist, I came to realize that a balanced, well-planned diet is the most essential part of effective fat loss.

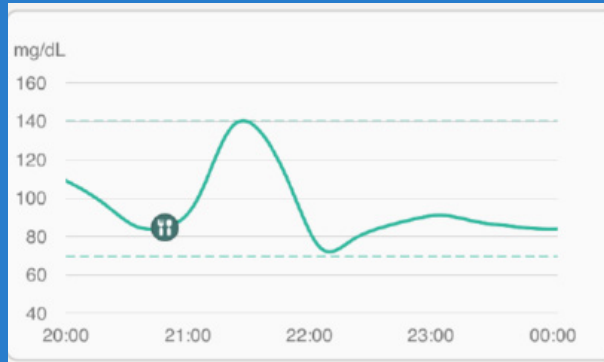
Design Process

So, what should tableware truly look like if it is to support a healthy, fat-loss lifestyle? This is the question I hope to explore more deeply in my upcoming design work.



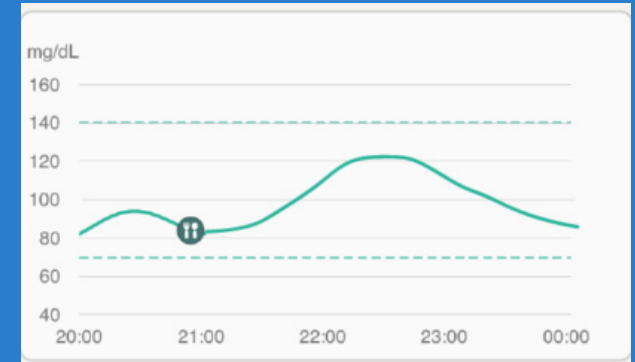
One of the most important steps in the weight-loss plan designed by my nutritionist is to follow **a proper eating order**: vegetables first, then protein, and finally carbohydrates.

Many meals that don't look like typical "diet food" can still support weight loss if eaten in the right way and at the right time. Conversely, some foods that seem healthy or low in sugar might cause sharp spikes in blood glucose, making them less ideal for fat loss. This is because weight gain isn't just about calories or sugar alone — it's also about how our body reacts, especially in terms of blood sugar and insulin levels. A meal that keeps blood sugar steady can be more helpful for managing weight than one that appears lighter but causes rapid fluctuations.



carbohydrates - protein - vegetables

This sequence led to a sharp spike in blood glucose shortly after eating, followed by a rapid drop.



vegetables - protein - carbohydrates

This approach resulted in a much more stable blood sugar curve, with a slower rise and a more gradual decline.

Such a pattern helps the body manage glucose more efficiently and prevents excess sugar from being rapidly stored as fat. This comparison illustrates how traditional eating habits — beginning with vegetables — can support better metabolic health and weight control. It reminds us that not only what we eat, but how we eat it, plays a vital role in how our bodies process food.



Tibetan Buddhism
elements

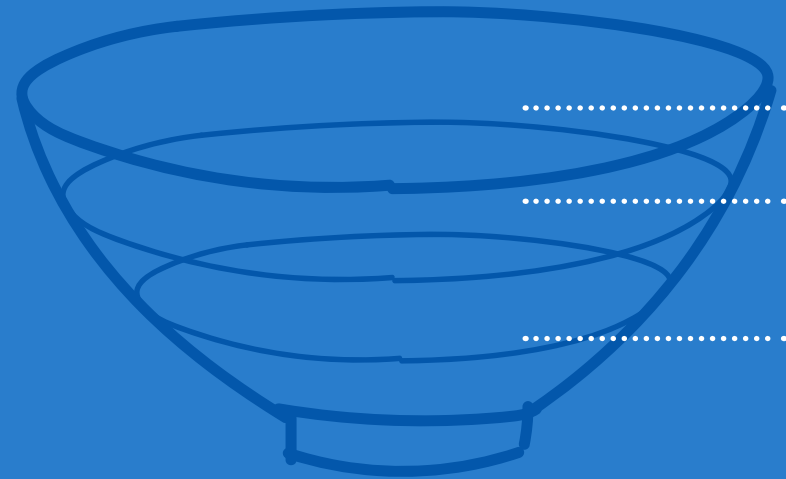
Islamic decorative
style

Han Chinese culture

Islamic decorative
style

Tibetan Buddhism
elements

This Yuan dynasty vase reflects a remarkable blend of cultural influences, with its five decorative layers telling a story of cross-cultural exchange.



vegetables

protein

carbohydrates

The “weight-loss bowl” is designed to be simple, healthy, and visually appealing, making balanced eating effortless. Inspired by the layered blue-and-white porcelain of the Yuan dynasty, I divided the bowl into three clear levels. This structure not only shows the right portions for each food group but also gently guides people to eat in a healthier order, helping stabilize blood sugar and improve satiety. With just one bowl, you have a complete, nutritious meal — no need to overthink what to eat or how to serve it.

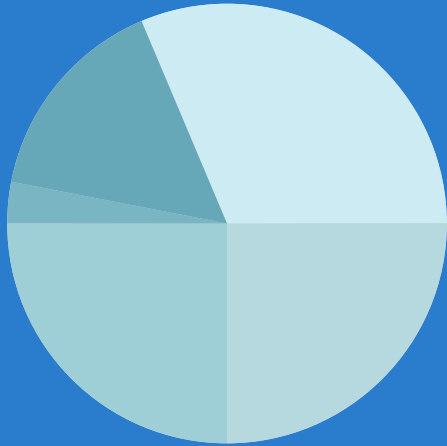
Making Process



After finalizing the meal plan, I created clear illustrations for each ingredient and mapped them onto the bowl's inner wall, marking both the grams needed and the total calories. By measuring how high each layer should be, the bowl becomes a simple visual guide, showing exactly what and how much to eat.

Design Process

Analyse the Recipe



Choose your greens 30%

lettuce leafy greens
spinach cabbage
Kale

Choose your fruits 25%

orange apple
blue berris banana

Choose your protein 25%

chicken beef
egg fish

Add healthy fat 5%

olive oil
avocado

Add complex carbohydrates 15%

brown rice
sweet potatoes

The second meal plan my nutritionist gave me was a well-balanced salad recipe. That inspired me to think: how could I translate this nutritional formula into a visual design — directly onto the tableware itself?



Inspired by the “window panel” designs of traditional blue-and-white porcelain, I then applied this concept to create a salad plate divided into distinct sections for each food group.

Making process



This plate was carefully designed and sketched out in my drafts, dividing it into five clear sections. Each zone is labeled with recommended weights and examples of foods, making it easy to build a balanced meal while still allowing for personal choice. By laying out the plate this way, it becomes a simple, intuitive tool to guide healthier, well-portioned eating in everyday life.

Logo Design

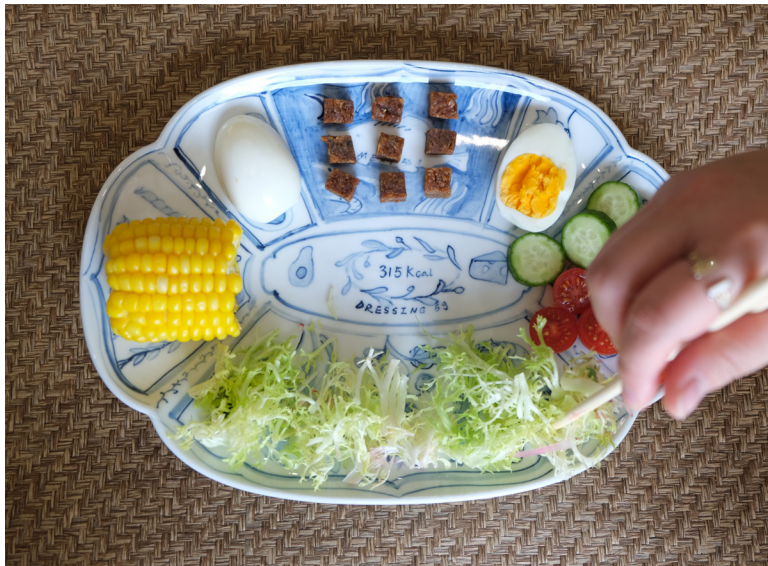
Savorslim Blueware

The name Savorslim Blueware beautifully captures the essence of this product. “Savor” suggests enjoying food with care and appreciation, while “slim” highlights its purpose of mindful portioning and supporting a healthy lifestyle. “Blueware” draws inspiration from the timeless elegance of blue-and-white porcelain, connecting the design to Chinese ceramic traditions. Together, the name weaves a story that blends cultural heritage, practical function, and the emotional appeal of bringing graceful, health-focused art to the dining table.

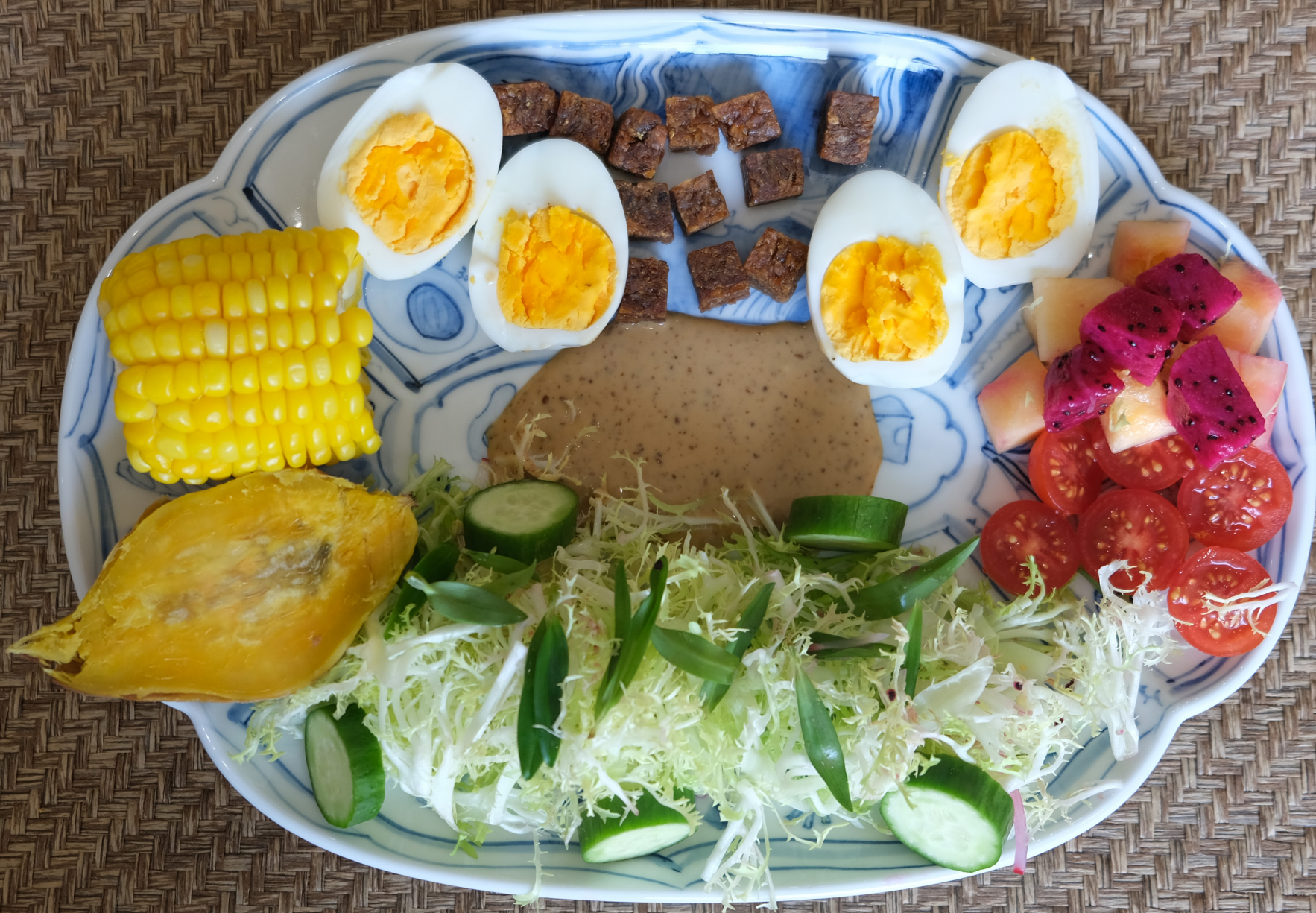


This is the logo I designed for my bowl, named Savorslim Blueware. The overall shape of the logo resembles the letter S, which represents both “Savor” and “Slim”—two key concepts at the heart of this product: enjoying food while staying healthy. The bottom curve of the S is shaped like a traditional blue-and-white porcelain bowl, directly referencing the Chinese Qinghua aesthetic that inspired the design of the actual product.





By simply following the layout and filling each area with the corresponding ingredients, users can enjoy a nutritionally balanced dish without needing to weigh or calculate anything themselves. Once plated, the ingredients not only look harmonious, but they also reflect a scientifically planned meal structure, making healthy eating both beautiful and effortless.



Marketing Analysis

STP Theory (Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning):

- **S:** Serving modern consumers who care about health but are often overwhelmed by the complexity of nutrition and meal planning.
- **T:** Urban women aged 20 to 40, many of whom have light physical workloads and fast-paced lives. They often wish to eat healthier and manage their weight but lack the time or knowledge to plan balanced meals.
- **P:** High aesthetics + high functionality + traditional culture = a functional lifestyle product that combines beauty and purpose.



4P Theory (Product, Price, Place, Promotion):

- **Product:** By visually layering the portions of a complete meal and clearly marking calorie counts and serving sizes, it makes nutritional information easier to understand and follow. This design also cleverly merges modern functionality with traditional Chinese art.
- **Price:** Affordable (to encourage healthy eating for all) with strong repeat purchase

potential (by regularly launching plates with different recipes).

- **Place:** Best suited for e-commerce platforms due to its novel concept, and also ideal as a highlight in exhibitions related to culture, lifestyle, and health, showcasing its story and aesthetic appeal.
- **Promotion:** Through storytelling marketing, nutritionist endorsements, and collaborations with ceramic culture brands.

